



WEBSITE · WWW.ANDRETHOMASLAW.COM

Accessibility Remediation Report

What the September 25, 2026 accessibility scan found, what was changed on the website in response, how the result was verified, and what the firm should do next.

PREPARED FOR

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DATE

September 27, 2026
Standard: WCAG 2.2 Level AA

The site now passes a full WCAG 2.2 AA scan on every page.

On September 25, 2026, Smart Scale ran an automated accessibility scan (axe-core, WCAG 2.2 Level AA plus best practice) across the English and Spanish sites at desktop and phone sizes. The site was already the cleanest of the three it was compared with, but the scan listed seven findings and could not measure the chat assistant at all.

All seven findings have been fixed, the chat assistant has been rebuilt to accessibility standards, and a further set of manual checks that no automated tool can make (keyboard operation, reduced motion, form error handling, links that open new tabs, image descriptions) has been carried out and the gaps closed. An accessibility statement page has been added in both languages and linked from the footer of every page.

144	0	7 + 5	2
automated scans of the finished site, across 68 pages at 1366px and 390px, including the chat open and the form in its error state	WCAG 2.2 A / AA violations remaining	scan findings fixed, plus five manual-check categories completed	languages, both with a skip link, correct language tagging, and the new accessibility statement

What this means for the firm

A visitor who relies on a screen reader, on the keyboard alone, on screen magnification, or on a reduced-motion setting can now read every page, use the contact form, and talk to the chat assistant. Beyond the people it serves, this reduces the firm's exposure to ADA Title III website demand letters, which typically cite exactly the kinds of defects that were found: missing focus indicators, low-contrast text, and forms that cannot be completed by keyboard.

Three things need the firm's attention. (1) The changes are built and verified but not yet deployed to the live site; once deployed, Smart Scale should be asked to rescan. (2) The new accessibility statement promises a reply *within two business days* to accessibility complaints sent to intake@andrethomaslaw.com or 713-212-3003. Please confirm the firm is comfortable with that commitment, or tell us what to change it to. (3) Please read the statement page itself (section 5) since it is published in the firm's name.

Seven findings, seven fixes.

FINDING (SEPTEMBER 25 SCAN)	WHAT WAS CHANGED	STATUS
1 Intake form had no visible keyboard focus. None of the nine fields showed a focus ring, on any page. (WCAG 2.4.7, 2.4.11)	Every link, button, and form field on the site now shows a 2px gold outline when reached with the keyboard, with 2px of clearance. The code that had switched the outline off on the form fields and the chat box was removed. The ring color was chosen to measure at least 3.7:1 against every background it can appear on, light or navy. Chrome's date field, which drops the ring on its calendar icon, has its own rule so the ring stays on for the whole control.	FIXED
2 Heading levels skipped from H1 to H3 on the home page in both languages, at the "Core Values and Approach" / "Valores y forma de trabajar" panels.	The two large display lines on the home page ("Why Andre Thomas Law, PLLC." and "Sixteen ways a life gets interrupted.", and their Spanish twins) are now true second-level headings. The panels and cards beneath them are third-level, so the outline reads H1 → H2 → H3. Every other page was audited for the same pattern; none had it.	FIXED
3 A sidebar landmark was nested inside the main landmark on the contact page and every practice-area page.	The two sidebars (office details on the contact page; the consultation box on practice-area pages) are now labelled regions rather than complementary landmarks, so a screen reader's landmark list no longer shows one inside the other.	FIXED
4 The Spanish site had no "skip to content" link.	Both languages now open with a skip link ("Skip to main content" / "Ir al contenido principal") that is the very first thing the Tab key reaches. Its target is focusable, so activating it actually moves the keyboard into the page rather than only scrolling. Verified on all 68 pages.	FIXED
5 Gold step numerals ("01", "02") on the team and reviews pages measured 3.1 to 3.4:1 on the light backgrounds; small text needs 4.5:1.	A darker shade of the brand gold (#7a5f1f) was added and is now used for every piece of gold text smaller than 24px on a light background: section numerals, eyebrow labels, role lines, dates, links, stars. It measures 5.3:1 on the warm paper and 5.7:1 on the plain paper. On the navy sections the original gold stays, where it already measured 5.3:1. Muted grey text at several sizes was also darkened for the same reason. The numerals themselves, being decorative counters, are no longer read aloud.	FIXED

6 Contrast could not be measured for the navigation links over the header gradient, the hero heading and text over the portrait, and section labels with decorative glyphs (50 to 76 items per page).	The header now carries a near-solid navy scrim (90 to 95%) for its full height, and the hero's two gradient washes were strengthened so the text always sits on at least 85 to 92% navy, even over the pale courthouse steps in the portrait. Because an automated tool still cannot see through a photograph, the real pixels behind each piece of text were sampled and measured; the results are in section 4. The decorative glyphs (◆, ★, arrows, separators) are now hidden from assistive technology.	FIXED
7 The bilingual chat assistant was not scanned. It must be keyboard operable, announce new messages, and keep focus inside while open.	The launcher button now announces itself as opening a dialog and whether it is open. The panel is a modal dialog: opening it moves the keyboard into the message box, Tab cycles only through the panel's controls, Escape closes it, and closing returns focus to the launcher. Each reply from the assistant is announced through a polite live region, and a "the assistant is typing" status is announced while it composes. Every intake question can be answered by keyboard, with a visible focus ring on every button and the text box. The chat is now part of every scan, in its open state, on both home pages.	FIXED

03 BEYOND THE SCAN

The checks a tool cannot make.

Automated scanners catch roughly a third of accessibility problems. The remaining items were checked by hand and by scripted keyboard walkthroughs, and the following changes were made.

Motion

Every animation on the site, including the scroll-reveal effects, the menu, and the chat panel, now honours the visitor's operating-system "reduce motion" setting through one site-wide switch. Two things move on their own for longer than five seconds, which the guidelines say must be pausable: the rotating word in the home-page headline and the scrolling ribbon of practice areas. Both now have a small pause/resume button beside them. The gentle pulse on the chat launcher now stops after five seconds. The ribbon also pauses itself whenever a keyboard user lands on one of its links, so the focus ring never slides off screen, and its duplicate second half is no longer in the tab order.

Links that open a new tab

All nine (Instagram, the Google Maps address links, the two "read reviews on Google" links, the SmartScale credit, and links inside chat replies) now carry the hidden text "(opens in new tab)" / "(se abre en una pestaña nueva)" for screen readers.

Contact form errors

Required fields were only marked with an asterisk; the form now also says "Fields marked * are required" in words. When a submission fails, a summary line is announced immediately, the keyboard is moved to the first field with a problem, each problem field is flagged as invalid, and its message is tied to it so a screen reader reads the field and its error together. Error text was also darkened from a red that measured 3.6:1 to one that measures 6.2:1.

Images

Every photograph was reviewed. The portraits, section photographs, and team headshots all carry descriptive text; the duplicate logo, the chat-panel logo, and the ornamental glyphs are hidden from assistive technology. No content image was missing a description.

Page structure and language

Every one of the 68 pages was checked for exactly one main heading and for the correct language tag (`en` or `es`) so that screen readers switch voice correctly. The Spanish pages still show client reviews in the English they were written in, and each is tagged as English for that reason.

Found along the way

- **Unknown web addresses** were showing the web framework's bare "404" page with no language, no skip link, and no main landmark. Both languages now serve the site's own "This page isn't here" page.
- **Focus hidden under the header.** The header floats over the page, so a field scrolled into view by the Tab key could land underneath it. The page now scrolls with a reserve at the top and bottom so the focused control is always clear of the header and the chat launcher.
- **Mobile menu.** Escape now closes it, focus returns to the menu button, and Tab stays inside the open menu.
- **The dismiss button on the chat's "Questions?" bubble** was 17px; the minimum tap target is 24px. Enlarged.
- **The footer's language link** said one thing on screen and another to assistive technology, which breaks voice-control commands. Aligned.

How the result was checked.

Automated scan

A scan script now ships with the website's code. It loads every page in the site map plus the legal pages and the 404 page, at 1366px and 390px wide, and runs axe-core with the WCAG 2.0, 2.1 and 2.2 A and AA rule sets. On the home pages it also opens the chat assistant; on the contact pages it submits the form empty. It then checks each page for one main heading, the right language tag, a working skip link, and no nested landmarks.

Result: 144 scans, 0 violations. Pages are loaded with reduced motion on, so every scroll-revealed section is fully visible when measured. This matters: the September 25 scan appears to have missed several contrast problems in sections that were still faded in at the moment it looked.

Each page still reports a couple of "incomplete" checks, meaning the tool could not measure them rather than that they failed: text over the header gradient, text over the film-grain texture on navy sections, and glyph-only elements. These are the items measured by hand below, and they will probably still show as "undetermined" in Smart Scale's rescan.

Keyboard walkthrough

Scripted, keyboard only, on the built site with normal motion settings:

- **Home:** the first Tab reaches the skip link; activating it moves focus into the page.
- **Practice-area page:** 74 tab stops, every one with a visible ring, every one fully on screen and clear of the header.
- **Contact form:** all twelve controls reachable in order; submitting empty announces the summary, moves focus to Name, and marks five fields invalid with their messages attached.
- **Chat:** Enter on the launcher opens it with focus in the message box; Tab cycles only through the panel; choosing a question by keyboard produces an announced reply; Escape closes it and returns focus to the launcher.
- **Mobile menu (390px):** Tab cycles within the open menu; Escape closes it and returns focus to the menu button.

Contrast measured behind text the scanner could not read

Real pixels were sampled from the finished pages beneath each piece of text, with the text hidden, and the worst (brightest) pixel compared against the text colour. Small text needs 4.5:1; text 24px and larger needs 3:1.

ELEMENT	SIZE	DESKTOP (1366PX)	PHONE (390PX)	REQUIRED
Navigation links over the header scrim	12.8px	18.2 : 1	7.5 : 1 (language link)	4.5 : 1
Hero headline over the portrait	94 / 42px	16.8 : 1	9.5 : 1	3 : 1

Hero gold eyebrow line	11px	7.7 : 1	7.0 : 1	4.5 : 1
Hero introduction paragraph	18 / 16px	10.6 : 1	10.2 : 1	4.5 : 1
Client quotation and attribution	16 / 12.5px	14.5 : 1 / 6.2 : 1	14.2 : 1 / 6.2 : 1	4.5 : 1
Section numerals on paper (new gold)	11px	5.3 : 1 warm paper · 5.7 : 1 plain paper (calculated)		4.5 : 1
Keyboard focus ring against every background	2px	3.7 : 1 or better (calculated)		3 : 1

05 THE ACCESSIBILITY STATEMENT AND WHAT COMES NEXT

A public commitment, in the firm's name.

The statement page

Published at **/accessibility** and **/es/accesibilidad**, linked as "Accessibility" / "Accesibilidad" in the footer of every page, and included in the site map. It says that the site targets WCAG 2.2 Level AA, describes what has been done, lists the known limitations, and invites anyone who has difficulty to call 713-212-3003 or email intake@andrethomaslaw.com with the page address and a description of the problem.

Known limitations it discloses: the Google Maps frame on the contact page is a third-party component outside the firm's control (the address, phone, and hours are also given as text); client reviews are reproduced verbatim and so appear in English on the Spanish site; and the chat assistant is automated and answers only from the website's content.

The commitment. The statement promises a response within two business days and an alternative format for any information a visitor could not reach. Whoever monitors the intake inbox should know to treat such messages as time-sensitive. If the firm prefers different wording or a different timeframe, it is a two-line change.

Next steps

STEP

OWNER

Deploy the updated site. The changes are complete and verified on a production build but have not yet been published.

DEVELOPER

Ask Smart Scale to rescan once the deploy is live. Expect zero violations and a small number of "undetermined" contrast items, explained in section 4.	DEVELOPER
Read the accessibility statement and confirm the two-business-day commitment and the contact details.	FIRM
Brief whoever handles the intake inbox and phone that accessibility complaints should be acknowledged within two business days.	FIRM
Run the scan (<code>npm run build && npm run ally</code>) before every future deploy, and keep to the conventions in the appendix when adding pages.	DEVELOPER
Optional: a session with a screen-reader user, or a professional manual audit, remains the gold standard beyond any scan or scripted check.	FIRM

What was deliberately not done

No accessibility "overlay" widget (accessiBe, UserWay, AudioEye and similar) was installed. These do not make a site conform, are frequently named in the very lawsuits they claim to prevent, and interfere with the assistive technology people already use. The visual design was not changed beyond what conformance required: a slightly deeper gold on small labels, a darker header scrim over photographs, and two small pause buttons.

A APPENDIX · TECHNICAL RECORD

What changed, file by file.

For the developer maintaining the site. 32 files were changed and 9 added; 661 lines added, 183 removed. Type-check, lint, and production build all pass.

FILE	CHANGE
src/app/globals.css	Site-wide <code>:focus-visible</code> ring (2px gold-700, 2px offset) on every interactive element; <code>gold-800</code> token; date-field focus rule; <code>scroll-padding</code> so focused controls clear the fixed header and launcher.
src/views/SiteShell.tsx · components/MotionProvider.tsx	Framer Motion <code>MotionConfig</code> <code>reducedMotion="user"</code> around the whole site; <code><main tabIndex=-1></code> as the skip-link target.
src/components/Nav.tsx	Near-solid header scrim; opaque link text and compliant active colour; <code>aria-current</code> ; labelled nav landmarks; mobile menu with Escape, focus trap, focus return, and <code>aria-controls</code> ; reduced-motion fallback for the menu reveal.

src/components/home/Hero.tsx	Stronger gradient scrims behind the text on both layouts; pause/resume button for the rotating word; decorative star hidden.
src/components/home/WhyFirm.tsx · FeaturedAreas.tsx · Ticker.tsx (new)	Display lines promoted to <code>h2</code> ; ticker extracted with a pause control, pause-on-focus, and its duplicate half removed from the accessibility tree and tab order.
src/components/Reveal.tsx	Eyebrow numerals hidden from assistive technology and coloured gold-800 on light backgrounds.
src/components/ContactForm.tsx	Namespaced ids; <code>aria-invalid</code> and <code>aria-describedby</code> per field; <code>role="alert"</code> summary; focus moved to the first error; "Fields marked * are required"; error and label colours brought to 4.5:1; <code>outline-none</code> removed; tone-aware success card.
src/components/chat/ChatWidget.tsx	<code>aria-haspopup</code> / <code>aria-controls</code> on the launcher; <code>aria-modal</code> dialog with focus-in, focus trap, Escape, and focus return; polite live region for replies and a typing status; launcher pulse capped at 5s; 24px dismiss target; new-tab text on external links; contrast of small text and icons.
src/views/ContactView.tsx · PracticeAreaView.tsx	<code><aside></code> replaced by <code><section aria-label></code> ; gold-800 labels; new-tab text; decorative arrows hidden; muted text darkened.
src/views/AboutView · ReviewsView · TeamView · TeamMemberView · PracticeAreasView · LegalView	Gold-800 for small gold text; large numerals hidden and re-coloured; muted grey text to 70% opacity or full ink-300 on navy; new-tab text on Google links.
src/components/Footer · CTABand · ReviewsBand · AboutPreview · PageHeader · Pillars · Portrait · NewTab.tsx (new)	"(opens in new tab)" component and its use on every external link; Accessibility footer link; label-in-name fix on the language link; stars, dots and arrows hidden; legal text to full ink-300.
src/lib/i18n.ts · content/types.ts · content/en.ts · content/es.ts	New <code>accessibility</code> route; strings for the skip link, new-tab hint, nav label, pause/resume, required note, error summary, typing status, footer link; the full accessibility statement in both languages.
src/app/(en)/accessibility · (es)/es/accesibilidad · (en)/[...rest] · (es)/es/[...rest] · (es)/not-found.tsx · sitemap.ts	Statement pages; catch-all routes so unknown URLs render the site's own 404 in each language; statement in the sitemap.
scripts/allly-scan.mjs · package.json · README.md	The scan script (<code>npm run allly</code>), its two dev dependencies (<code>@axe-core/playwright</code> , <code>playwright</code>), and the conventions that keep it green.

Conventions for future changes

- Never use `outline-none` without a replacement focus ring.
- No `<aside>` inside `<main>`; use `<section aria-label>`. One `h1` per page, no skipped levels.
- Gold text under 24px on a light background uses `gold-800`. Muted body text is `ink-800/70` or darker on light, full `ink-300` on navy.
- Every `target="_blank"` link includes `<NewTab lang />`. Purely decorative glyphs get `aria-hidden`.
- Anything that moves for more than five seconds on its own needs a pause control and must respect reduced motion.

ANDRE THOMAS LAW, PLLC

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Report prepared September 27, 2026, from a production build of www.andrethomaslaw.com. Automated testing used axe-core via @axe-core/playwright in Chromium; measurements were made on that build and will be repeated by Smart Scale after deployment. Conformance claims refer to the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.2, Level AA, published by the W3C.